

Block 2 — The Loop & The Goal

Goal

Give Claude a real business goal and watch it figure out how to achieve it step by step. Claude will read the data, plan its approach, write and run Python, and report back — all without you touching any code. Your job is to approve each step and verify the result.

Type this

1. Start Claude Code if it is not already running: `claude`
2. Paste this into the chat: Here is a sales file: `data/orders.csv`. I want a monthly sales report - total revenue per month, and which month was best. Plan your approach first, then do it.
3. Claude will show you a short plan (something like "I'll read the file, compute $\text{quantity} \times \text{unit_price}$, group by month, and find the maximum"). When it pauses and asks whether to continue, type: Yes, go ahead.
4. Once it finishes and shows you numbers, ask it to confirm the key result: What was the best month, and what was its revenue?

Tip — plan mode. If you want Claude to *only* plan and never act without an explicit green light, press `Shift+Tab` twice before sending your first message. That switches to plan mode (`Shift+Tab` cycles: default → `acceptEdits` → plan). In plan mode Claude reads and proposes, but makes no changes until you say so.

You should see

- A short, plain-English plan before any code runs.
- Claude writing a small Python script and executing it on its own.
- A monthly table with one row per month and a "best month" callout.
- The answer to your verification question: **the best month is 2024-12 (December)**.

If it looks wrong

- The numbers don't add up, or December is not the best month: That doesn't match - December should be the best month. Re-check how you computed revenue ($\text{quantity times unit_price}$).
- Claude asks for a file path it can't find: The file is at `data/orders.csv` relative to this folder. Try again.
- Claude stops mid-task: Please continue where you left off.